FACULTY REFERENCE · OCTOBER 2026

VTLM 2.0
Alignment Guide

Where this suite meets the Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0, where it was changed to meet it, and where it stops. Written for faculty leaders documenting VTLM implementation.

4 elements of learning | 4 elements of teaching | 5 lessons resequenced | Retrieval added

What changed in October 2026, and why

Until this revision the Year 7–8 lesson plans were built on the **5E model** — Engage, Explore, Explain, Elaborate, Evaluate. 5E is a constructivist inquiry model whose defining feature is that students *explore before the teacher explains*.

VTLM 2.0 inverts that. Explicit teaching sits at the model's core, and the department states it is the most effective approach for most students, including priority cohorts. The sequence is explanation and modelling first, then scaffolded practice.

Three lessons genuinely ran Explore before Explain and have been resequenced. The activities themselves were already tightly directed rather than open discovery, so the content changed very little — what changed is the order, the naming, and the addition of a retrieval phase that did not previously exist anywhere in the unit.

1. The four elements of learning

These describe how learning happens. The department's wording is summarised in the left column; the suite's response is on the right.

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Element	What the model says	How this suite addresses it
Attention, focus and regulation	Active engagement and focused attention move new information into long-term memory. Supported by minimising distractions, suitable challenge, rules and routines, and belonging.	Every lesson opens with a short, predictable routine — retrieval starter, then a focus statement. Differentiated versions (scaffolded, simplified, extension) set the challenge at the right level rather than one level for all. The cultural considerations resource addresses belonging directly.
Knowledge and memory	Working memory is where students engage with new knowledge. Learning occurs when it moves into long-term memory and connects with existing mental models.	Content is introduced in small chunks with teacher explanation before practice. The glossary gives consistent definitions across all 51 resources, so terminology does not shift between tasks and add avoidable load.
Retention and recall ← newly addressed	Working memory is limited, so new information works best in small chunks. Practising and recalling strengthens retention and makes knowledge easier to apply.	**This was the suite's clearest gap.** Across five sequential lessons there was no retrieval practice, no spaced review and no lesson-opening recap. Lessons 2–5 now open with a three-minute low-stakes retrieval starter drawn from prior lessons, cumulative and ungraded.
Mastery and application	Spaced, varied and repeated practice consolidates learning and supports transfer. Once students have the knowledge, they can engage more effectively in problem solving.	14 scenario cards, the interactive quiz, two question banks and the summative communication campaign give varied application of the same core knowledge. The Year 9–10 assessment requires transfer to an unfamiliar community context.

2. The four elements of teaching

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Element	Evidence in this suite	Where to look
Planning	Curriculum codes on 37 resources; a unit overview with scope and sequence across both bands; achievement standard connections stated per band; a full curriculum coverage map showing which content descriptions the unit does and does not address.	Unit Overview · Curriculum Coverage Map · Teacher Resource Guide
Enabling learning	EAL/D and diverse-learner provision across 48 resources. Scaffolded and simplified workbook versions at both year levels, with word banks and sentence starters. Multilingual parent information. Cultural considerations guidance written around structural inequity rather than deficit.	Diverse Learners Visual Guide · Simplified and Scaffolded Workbooks · Cultural Considerations
Explicit teaching	All five Year 7–8 lessons now follow the explicit teaching sequence. Teacher explanation and modelling precede student practice in every lesson. See section 3 for the phase-by-phase mapping.	Teacher Resource Guide, Lessons 1–5
Supported application	Guided practice is distinguished from independent application in every lesson. Workbook activities are sequenced from teacher-modelled to independent. Assessment offers three task options with checklists and an A–E rubric.	Student Workbooks · Assessment Rubric · Community Action Project Guide

A limit worth stating

The department publicly names the four practices within *Explicit teaching*. The sub-strategies for Planning, Enabling learning and Supported application sit in the VTLM 2.0 guides on Arc, which require a departmental login. This guide therefore maps confidently against the four elements and the named explicit teaching practices, and does not invent sub-strategy names for the other three.

If your school has Arc access, the Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool and the VTLM 2.0 Implementation Rubric are the right instruments for a finer-grained audit.

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3. The lesson sequence, phase by phase

Every Year 7–8 lesson now runs in this order. The phase names match the model's own language.

1. **Review — retrieval practice** · 3 min *(new — did not exist before October 2026)*
   Three or four questions from prior lessons, no notes, self-marked. Ungraded. Lessons 2–5. Addresses *Retention and recall*.

2. **Focus the learning** · 5–10 min *(was Engage)*
   Hook, learning intention and success criteria. Students know what they are learning and what success looks like before anything else happens.

3. **Explicit teaching — I do** · 8–15 min *(was Explain, now moved before practice)*
   Teacher explanation and modelling, in small chunks, with a visual reference. In Lesson 3 this is a physical demonstration of CPR technique.

4. **Guided practice — we do** · 12–15 min *(was Explore)*
   Students apply the modelled content with teacher support and checking. Activities unchanged; position in the sequence changed.

5. **Independent application — you do** · 8–30 min *(was Elaborate)*
   Workbook activities, scenario analysis and, in Lesson 5, the summative assessment task.

6. **Monitor progress** · 5–12 min *(was Evaluate)*
   Exit ticket, role-play check, gallery walk or self-assessment. Every lesson ends with a check on whether the success criteria were met.

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What was *not* changed

The activities themselves. The Explore phases were already directed tasks with stated timings and specific workbook references — "complete Activity 1.1 independently, 5 minutes" — not open investigation. Resequencing them as guided practice reflects what they always were.

The Year 9–10 teacher guide was never built on 5E. It uses a Know / Understand / Do structure, which already sits comfortably within the model and was left alone.

4. Cognitive load

The model states that explicit teaching is designed to manage cognitive load, and that new information should be introduced in small chunks because working memory is limited. Three specifics in this suite:

- **Worked examples.** The Year 9–10 data pack shows worked calculations before asking students to perform their own. This is the clearest cognitive-load management in the suite and the pattern worth extending.
- **Consistent terminology.** One glossary serves all 51 resources, so a term does not change meaning between a poster and a workbook.
- **Differentiated entry points.** Scaffolded, standard and extension versions mean the same content can be pitched at three load levels rather than one.

An honest gap: beyond the data pack, the suite relies more on answer keys than on modelled worked examples. Answer keys show the destination; worked examples show the route. Extending worked examples through the Year 9–10 calculation tasks would be the next improvement.

5. Using this with your Annual Implementation Plan

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If your school is documenting VTLM 2.0 implementation, this unit can evidence:

- **Explicit teaching** — five lessons with the full sequence, teacher explanation preceding practice, timings stated.
- **Retention and recall** — cumulative retrieval starters across a sequential unit, a practice that is easy to claim and hard to evidence.
- **Enabling learning** — differentiated versions at both bands, not just extension tasks bolted on.
- **Monitor progress** — a check against success criteria in every lesson, plus rubrics and self-assessment.

What it cannot evidence on its own is whole-school consistency, which is what the Implementation Rubric assesses. A single unit is a data point, not a program.

Sources

Department of Education Victoria. *Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0* — policy, guidance and resources. www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/victorian-teaching-learning-model

Element descriptions are summarised from the department's published guidance. The full VTLM 2.0 document and the teaching strategy guides are on Arc Learning (departmental login required).

Related evidence linked from the department's VTLM resources page includes Rosenshine's *Principles of Instruction*, AERO's *How students learn best*, and CESE's cognitive load theory summary.

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Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0 · Health and Physical Education · Levels 7–10
Lesson sequence resequenced to VTLM 2.0 in October 2026. Retrieval practice added at the same revision.

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